TITLE PAGE: contains author information. Do not include it in the anonymized manuscript, the supplementary PDF or the code archives.

Deference or Noise? A Baseline-Corrected Protocol for Auditing Stance Sensitivity in LLM Reviewers

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Index terms Large language models, sycophancy, evaluation methodology, reliability, AI-assisted decision making, benchmark.

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Data and code The item bank, generator, audit program, runner, analysis code and raw model outputs are provided as anonymized supplementary archives (S1, S2).